

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 631

By Hemmer

A RESOLUTION to commend A.J. Starling for his honorable service as a member of the Davidson County Election Commission.

WHEREAS, it is fitting that the members of this General Assembly should pause to specially recognize those estimable public servants who have dedicated themselves to improving the quality of life for their fellow citizens; and

WHEREAS, A.J. Starling is one such estimable person who evinces the greatest integrity and probity in all his chosen endeavors; and

WHEREAS, having served with distinction since 2003 as a member of the Davidson County Election Commission, A.J. Starling is taking his well-deserved retirement from that esteemed body; and

WHEREAS, currently serving as the secretary/treasurer of the Tennessee AFL-CIO, Mr. Starling has enjoyed a storied career in the labor movement since 1971, when he was a bus operator and member of the Amalgamated Transit Union Local 1235 in Nashville; and

WHEREAS, he was later elected to the Union Executive Board and eventually Recording Secretary of Local 1235, where he served for twelve years; and

WHEREAS, during his tenure as a bus operator, Mr. Starling received recognition as Operator of the Year and received the Perfect Attendance Award and Safe Driving Award for eighteen years, as well as the Brooks-Starling Award, named in honor of Mr. Starling and his supervisor, Frank Brooks, which is given annually to the operator who has gone above and beyond the call of duty; and

WHEREAS, in 1988, Mr. Starling was selected to serve as labor coordinator in the Technical Assistance Program for the Tennessee AFL-CIO, where he worked with the Tennessee Department of Labor in the Dislocated Workers Unit, assisting hundreds of people to secure training and re-employment; and

WHEREAS, within two years, he was promoted to Director of the Technical Assistance Program, where he planned and supervised all phases and operations; under his leadership, the program's staff doubled, and the annual budget grew to over half a million dollars before he was named Director of Political Affairs for the Tennessee AFL-CIO in 2003; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Starling has lent his time and talents as a member of the Workforce Investment Board (WIA#9), the State of Tennessee Tax Structure Study Commission, the Red Cross Board, state president of the Asa Phillip Randolph Institute, and trustee of Westwood Baptist Church; and

WHEREAS, a devoted husband and father, A.J. Starling enjoys the love and support of his wife, Marieta, and his two sons, Jeff and Andrae; and

WHEREAS, throughout his exemplary tenure as a member of the Davidson County Election Commission, A.J. Starling has distinguished himself as a public-spirited citizen of the highest order and as an exceptional asset to his community; and

WHEREAS, A.J. Starling is wholly committed to the noble precepts of public service that have earned Tennessee recognition as the Volunteer State, and he should be specially recognized; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we hereby commend A.J. Starling for his honorable and astute service to the good people of Tennessee as a member of the Davidson County Election Commission and salute his unswerving commitment to living the examined life with courage and conviction.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.